JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Forward Deployed Engineer with a passion for solving problems in the field where they actually matter. After studying Computer Science at the University of Leeds, I spent my first year working directly with customers to understand their technical challenges and deliver practical solutions. I'm most comfortable troubleshooting infrastructure issues, writing automation scripts, and bridging the gap between engineering teams and the real world. I enjoy learning new tools quickly and getting things working rather than overcomplicating solutions.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

Vortex Systems Ltd

https://www.vortex-systems.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

Deployed and maintained Kubernetes clusters at three customer sites in the financial services sector, handling troubleshooting calls from on-site teams and providing remote support within two-hour response times

Automated infrastructure monitoring by writing Python scripts that reduced manual health checks by 80 percent and caught configuration drift issues before they caused outages

Built custom dashboards in Grafana for three enterprise clients to visualize application performance metrics, resulting in faster incident detection and response

Documented deployment procedures and runbooks for each customer environment, enabling their ops teams to handle routine maintenance without escalation

Junior Systems Administrator

CloudBridge Consulting

https://www.cloudbridge-consulting.co

Leeds, United Kingdom

August 2022 - February 2023

Managed AWS infrastructure for twelve small to medium sized business clients, performing daily monitoring, security updates, and cost optimization reviews

Diagnosed and resolved server connectivity issues across Windows and Linux environments, reducing average resolution time from four hours to forty minutes through systematic troubleshooting

Implemented automated backup solutions using Ansible, protecting critical data for clients across multiple geographical regions

Supported the senior team during business hours migrations and coordinated with clients to schedule downtime windows

IT Support Technician

Pinnacle Group

https://www.pinnaclegroup.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

June 2021 - July 2022

Provided first and second line technical support to approximately 150 internal staff across three office locations, resolving hardware, software, and network connectivity issues

Imaged and deployed new workstations using MDT and Group Policy, onboarding thirty new employees throughout my tenure

Maintained the company's VMware vSphere environment, managing virtual machine creation, snapshots, and resource allocation across hosts

Documented IT processes and created knowledge base articles that reduced repeat support tickets by forty percent

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Leeds

Leeds, United Kingdom

2018 - 2021

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services (EC2, S3, RDS, VPC), basic Google Cloud Platform experience

Infrastructure and Deployment: Kubernetes, Docker, VMware vSphere, Ansible, Terraform

Monitoring and Logging: Grafana, Prometheus, ELK Stack, CloudWatch

Programming and Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS), Windows Server 2019 and 2022, macOS

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, VPN configuration, basic firewall management, network troubleshooting

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, basic DynamoDB

Version Control: Git, GitHub

Other Tools: Jira, Confluence, ServiceNow, PuTTY, WireShark

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

https://github.com/jrichardson92/k8s-monitoring-setup

Kubernetes monitoring stack deployment using Prometheus and Grafana, includes custom alert configurations for common cluster issues and dashboards for resource utilization tracking.

https://github.com/jrichardson92/aws-infrastructure-automation

Terraform modules for deploying VPCs, RDS databases, and EC2 instances with security best practices, includes example configurations for typical three-tier application architectures.

https://github.com/jrichardson92/system-health-monitor

Python utility that monitors Linux and Windows server health metrics, sends alerts via email and Slack, and generates weekly availability reports for client review.

https://github.com/jrichardson92/ansible-workstation-config

Ansible playbooks for configuring development workstations with common tools, Docker, and required dependencies, used internally at CloudBridge for consistent onboarding.